

Sat March 27

Spent 2 lovely days at the Sand hills anchorage on South Moreton Island. We climbed the huge sand dunes that went on ridge after ridge. It was like a desert - nothing to see but sand in the middle. Today we had a fast and rilly sail up to Moo loo laba. Char-lotte really got moving, downwind in 20 knots. The bar at Moo loo laba was ^{expecting} - we came in between the buoys and the breakers. It is nice to be here again - there was a bike race down town you watched. Thomas was happy with his boat performance today!

Sat April 10

How easy to spend 2 weeks in Moo loo laba! Brian spent a weekend with Ben on Ondulgerce and was at the beach boogie-boarding every day. Saw Suleika with Katherine, Martin & Will. Then La Passarella with Les, Colleen, Gordon & Amy, came up from Southport; also Queller with Tim, Trish and boy Matthew & David. We had a barbeque in the park. Did lots of walking as usual. Today we left at sunrise, back to Wides Bay Bay, re tracing our path to the north of Fraser Island. Very rilly, big swell, Char-lotte happy with 20 knots, we have to slow the boat down to time a low tide arrival. The bar was breaking all across when we arrived, kind of scary but we made it through. Anchored right next to a sand bank - wondered why the birds were making such a racket in the dark.

Sund April 11

Happy Easter! Cruising up the Sandy Straits today, in company with Passarella. Nice sunny day, calm seas, much nicer than yesterday!

Mon April 12 2003

Spent one last evening with La Passanola at White Cliffs anchorage. Today we left early, motored 2 hours in light wind, then sailed north out 2 knots per hour. Finally out into Heavy Bay open water at 2 pm and doing 4 knots with motor drifted up. Guess we will continue all night to today Musgrave Reef. Nice weather, calm seas.

Tues April 15

Arrived at Lady Musgrave Tuesday morning. Heat a calm day here, cleaned the bottom, & did some snorkelling. Pretty colors on the reef, violet, periwinkle, baby blue, bright yellow, electric blue. Tonight a mackerel approaching the reef, so Thomas and Brian lit well. Wednesday the wind was up, they did some wind surfing. Beautiful shades of blue over the lagoon! Now we are sailing. Pancake Creek on the main land, a 35-mile sail. Nice 10 knot wind, some swell, not rolling too much.

Wed April 16

Pancake Creek was interesting, would have liked to walk the sandbars and explore the island. However we got underway at 5 am, still think now that it is no longer summer! Hearing a great sail today, 11 knots, dead downwind, 5 1/2 - 6 knots. Heading for Great Keppel Island, on a 6 ft run 65-mile run. We just crossed the Tropic of Capricorn, which passes through Cape Capricorn. Back in the tropics!

Thurs April 17

Relaxed all night at Great Keppel Island. So now we are underway again, 11 knots are low, all we want is a nice place to spend a day or 2. It would be nice to walk again. The next good anchorage is over 200 miles away. Winds light today, guess we will stop at Port Clinton and see what the wind will do.

Sun April 18

Today is a much happier day! We spent a quiet night at Port Clinton - but there inundated by gales in the morning. We left with light east winds, which have continued all day. It is slow going, but the sun is warm and the swells are down. More comfortable than some anchorages! I guess we will continue overnight to Seawall Island.

Mon April 19

The wind was so light yesterday we finally gave up and motored to High Peak for the night. We weren't the only one to make only 35 miles today. But at least Thomas gets a mackerel for dinner every day! Had a quiet evening and set off again today. Once against light winds but it is comfortable enough out here. The hottest day we have had in a while. Only 3 knots average but I guess it's better than sitting still.

Tues April 20

It has been an interesting sail the past week among the rocky islands. At times the current grips our keel so ~~for~~ hard we can barely go forward. Even now, there are white caps and ~~we~~ seem to be making good progress, but the GPS shows speed hardly 4 knots. We never seem to have the current with us, only against us. We had a pleasant night with some good sailing. At times we are under full main, pole-d-out genoa, yankee and mizzen, we still don't maintain 5 knots. But we have done 3, and we will anchor this evening at Goldsmith Island, in sight of the Whit Sunday. The weather is tropical again - we are at 20° latitude. Feels great!

11th April 28
Spent in the Whit Sunday. We sailed to Cid Harbor on Whit Sunday
1st. It was a calm comfortable stop, small rocky beach with a
mark. We ~~stayed~~ in the woods some, got scared by big snarly-
looking spiders! Then sailed 15 miles to Culier Beach to get fresh
food - good vegetable market on Saturday morning. We enjoyed the
fresh water lagoon in the middle of town. Looked at some incredible
spiders in a local store. This morning, in the squally heavy
weather, we sailed out to Hook Island. Sitting at a mooring now,
in the rain, pretty place with steep rocky hillsides, clear blue
water. Will go out to the reef at Bird Island when the
weather clears.

12th April 28
Hook Island was nice, we enjoyed the convenience of a mooring.
When did get to go snorkeling, the boys refused to go. At 11 AM
they with charter boats. Today the sun shone, so of course we
had to leave! Light winds so we sailed to Gloucester Passage to
wait the wind change. Forecast for tomorrow.

13th April 30
Spent yesterday in Gloucester Passage, moved around a bit when
the wind turned west. Light wind and lots of rain. Left there
morning with 20-25 SW, great sailing for a while, 6-7 knots on
reach. Of course it didn't last and now we are underway
again, after a total wind stall, light NE winds. At least
the air pointed in the right direction. It was quite nice
sailing for some time. Destination the Palm Islands north of
Pantabed.

Sat May 1

Happy May Day! It is quite an enjoyable day out here so we decided to continue on to Cairns. 15 knots from the south so we are poled out, rolling along. Supposed to blow 20-25 the next 3 days so we want to get in. Lots of islands sticking out everywhere, a lot of cargo traffic.

Sun May 2

Sailing along the NE Queensland coast, Thomas says it is hard to believe there are 7 billion people in the world. The hills are rougher and more jagged here. Hinchinbrook Island looks quite forbidding from sea. It is hard to believe that all the reefs of the Great Barrier Reef are just a few miles to windward. The channel is much narrower here, 15-10 miles wide. Lots of cargoes, all on the same path as us. Why do we see them mostly at night? The night sails have been calm, if a bit frustrating with constant wind changes. The sea is warm, you can actually sit in the cockpit and be marginally comfortable. Today we are flying along, poled out, at 6-7 knots in 15-20 knots of wind. The current has been in our favor the past two days. We plan to drop anchor late this afternoon in Mission Bay, just east of Cairns harbor. Cairns will be a time of making more decisions - oh horror! But I think we had enjoyed these 2 1/2 days at sea and the time for reflection they have afforded.

Thurs May 20

Two weeks in Cairns, we were glad to get away, although we liked the city. Hauled out and painted the bottom at the Cairns Cruising Yacht Club. People were all very friendly and helpful. There was a nice lagoon downtown, but unfortunately it closed for repairs. I enjoyed

The bee morning experience lasted - took one on potatoes and the other. The Pilatus is for me! I splashed and brought myself on pedal. The car ran into Soya - Roger & Uipa - on the deck. They were traveling by car and took us for a drive to Port Douglas and up on the mountain. Got bucked out or shopping centers - we have seen too many in Australia! But finally other evening boats caught up with us and we had a evening ashore with Tent Dig on Falls Tree and Chut + Mandy on Bedouin. Left Cairns Tuesday morning for Michaelmas Cay where we enjoyed some fantastic snorkeling - creditably alive reefs with bright blue elkhorn coral, tons of colorful reef fish, and a bunch of giant blue-legged clams. They are so weird - I had fun messing with them, trying to get them to close - and they do, even though their shells look as though they could never move again. The little sand cay was home to thousands of birds who made a constant non-stop racket, even at night. The forest birds were quiet and didn't really bother us. The morning we headed for Low Islands, 27 miles away. Great sailing inside the Russell Reef, Charlotte averaged, over 6 knots today in 20-25 knots. That makes Thomas happy. Spanish does not make Bird happy. I am amazed. I am very happy to be swimming and snorkeling again. It feels like we are finally cruising.

May 21
Another smooth boat ride! The wind was down this morning, much more comfortable in 15-20 knots. By the time we reached Hope Islands, it was bonking again. Low Islands didn't thrill us, forest boats, but the beach, usually green water - probably due to the mangroves - all a whole lot of fishing boats. But Thomas had caught another small and we celebrated it on Bedouin with Chut + Mandy. This place has no forests, lots of coral, a pasture sandy beach.

Mon May 23

Once again we are flying up the reef - 6-7 knots in 20-25 K. Spent 2 pleasant days at Hope Island, walked around on the beach, cleaned the bottom. Nasty for nacles from Corals, even after a new paint job. The reefs looked great, but the water was disappointing murky. Guess we will go into Cooktown for a day or two.

Mon May 24

We spent a pleasant afternoon wandering around Cooktown, although it rained almost constantly. Lots of Captain Cook memorabilia. The anchorage was a bit tight and all the locals stared at us from the docks. Moved on this morning to Lizard Island! The first leg was to windward - don't understand how Captain Cook ever got out of there! It is blowing 20-25 as usual and with wind forward of the beam, not so comfortable. We sailed up to the lagoon anchorage at Lizard but there were no boats there. But Watsons Bay is quite nice.

Wed June 2

Finally tore our selves away from Lizard Island, had a great time there. Nice bunch of cruises, including Thal Tree with Liz & Tom, nice Tracy who lives in Atlanta, Bedouin, the Dutch boats Crest and Barache, Tranquillity, South African Just Girl, English Astika. We hiked to Cooks Blount with a breath taking view of the lagoon. We hiked to the lagoon with an snorkel gear and dove the reefs out there, we looked at huge fish and giant clams! Bitten head here, with all the people, no time to play computer games! Monday we did the tour of the research station. Going night we had happy hour on the beach, lots of walking, swimming!

and socializing. There was even a well with a hand pump
so I could do laundry every day! Time passed quickly. At
last a magic spot. But today we moved on, 30 miles to
Hawick Island. Fast sailing as usual.

June 3
Another good run - 50 miles to Stanley Island in the Elkins
Group. On company with Ted, Joe and Tranquility. We were
the leaders and stayed that way all day - what a thrill!
The boat has been really going well lately - must be the
moment. Cape Melville was very rough with a confused sea,
inland by 2:30, great day with a lot of work sailing a
pilot.

June 6
Spent an extra day in the Elkins Group, as we had trouble
finding the cause pointings. Friday we started our assault
on land in company with Ted, Joe, Badwin, and Baccanor.
We then took over land and through bushes, got to the
beach where the original paintings were. Great to get to the
place where a hell that had a will. Radar emplacement at the
top. Never found it, but had a great view of the island in
the Elkins Group. That afternoon Tranquility joined us and
helped us how to get to the paintings. So Saturday morning we all
went on Bodwin to try again. We anchored in Quana. Chained
and took the dinghies across. The paintings were fantastic and!
and in opening - the first on plastic thing we have seen in Quana. It was
just the shiny side back was very big and in the center
with the extent.

Today what a sail! We had Tranquillity and Bedawin behind us all the way. Started out light, but picked up to 20 and we were charging along at 7.5 knots on a broad reach. The other boats could never catch up with us. I jumped in the water as soon as we arrived - no crocs here! Everyone enjoyed the change.

Tues June 8

Had a lay day at Morris - it is my last chance to swim and Thomas was hoping to withdraw but the wind just would enter right. We did have a nice long walk on the sand bars that uncovered at low tide and was astonished at the practicality of the sand bars themselves. In the sand is the beach to Portland. Today is a long - 60 miles - sail to Portland. tide went out. Today is a long - 60 miles - sail to Portland. Roads. Bedawin took most of the day to catch up with us. Anchored by 2 pm and everyone will enjoy fresh yellow fin tuna for dinner, thanks to Teel Tree.

Wed June 9

Sailing 42 miles to Margaret Bay around Cape Grenville. Will celebrate Brian's birthday with the group tonight since it is a short day. Under way, there as usual, 20-25 knots. We are getting so used to making 6 knots or more headstart, is the only boat that can pass us, with our headstart, is Bedawin. Tranquillity is the same speed, Teel Tree at 51, is faster but they sail conservatively. The last 2 mornings have been spectacular, sun rising and moon still shining bright in the sky. Brian got one of his new Game Boy games today so he is content.

June 10

Had happy hour and Giffthday cake on the beach last night with Bedown & Feal Tree, then dinner on Tranquillity. Wanted to make Brien spend the night in a small bed comfortable cause in the beach as had manhood site of - passage, but for some reason, he was not amenable! Dinner on Tranquillity was delicious & cozy. After a calmer beginning to the day with a beautiful bubble hour and we are having to reef down again. A lot more today. Brien got preoccupied from Bedown & Feal Tree, plus another game boy game - he is alternating between the 2, wishing he had cheated! Destination Bushy Islet today. Bedown left only to go through Albany Passage in one day.

June 11

Bye-bye Pacific Ocean! We had a pleasant walk on Bushy Islet and then the afternoon yesterday. Saw our first croc tracks and avoided a big turtle who was disoriented on the rocks. Brien let him go. The shallow lagoon. Rather uncomfortable night, pitching and rolling. The sailing today wasn't much better, we were down to 10 knots of 10 knots but not a dry sail. Didn't want to reach Albany passage before 3 pm. There was still a current running out and standing seas when we arrived. So Bushy Islet was our last night. Pacific and Great Barrier Reef island tomorrow we enter the Coral Sea. Calm anchorage here in Albany Pass at Shallow anchorage. Can't forget the high light of the day - we up head a 1000 crocodile swimming toward our boat, then he turned away when he saw we could not get aboard. About 2 feet long, he was 10 ft across in color and very strong in the big sea.

Sat June 12

Last day of sailing for now - we are bent out! Calm morning sailing in the lee of Cape York. We round York Island and affectually leave the Pacific. The current pull us - though the pass at Possession Island. Great sailing - to windward in flat seas. Bomaga harbor is picturesque, with sandy beaches and palm trees. Bedauin is here, tranquillity + quiet. Qimp arrive later. We are looking forward to resting for a day.

Mon June 14

Had a little happy hour on the beach last night with Teal Tree, Bedauin, Tranquillity, and Quiet Qimp. Walked to Bomaga the day before, not much happening, a quiet, neat a boi gine at 4 pm - all the sky high light was the opening of the liquor store at 4 pm - all the trucks in the vicinity were there to pick up one case of beer, all they are allowed! The terrain was different - red clay soil, tall grasses, eucalyptus trees. Left for Gave this morning with a light SE wind, but now it has died completely. The Gulf of Carpentaria is very rally, short seas.

Tues June 15

Brilliant night the wind picked up after dark, the seas were calm, the stars shining brightly and we were charging along at 7 knots for hours. By morning the seas were up, but still not too uncomfortable. We have maintained 6 knots, under full sails now, 15-20 knots, broad-reaching. Great sailings 24-hour run - 137 miles.

Wed June 14

Got hammered last night - 25-35 knots and continuing today. Finally took the main sail down at sunrise and aboared up the

Notes: All we can do is live around today, with beam seas making over the boat. Now we are on the final approach, motor- anding into it, what fun. Hope we is worth it. At least we have made last, the whole halfway between. Bedeum and Thompson's this morning. Charlotte can hardly move in the wind. 24-hour run - 154 miles

Jan 19

The ALCAN barge more fun was the high light of our stay in here. The effort they put into refueling the land and restoring it to its original state was commendable. The aboriginal harvest of meat and seeds from the indigenous plant life, dry them, mix them with soft sugar and seed when the ship moving is finished. The difference was that the land was about 10 feet lower after sinking. I also enjoyed a long swim in the Olympic-sized pool in the town. I had it all to myself. The final 15 miles approach to Gove was horrible - motor sailing in gale-force winds and the last 2 miles was agony, making hardly any headway. But it was worth it to drop the hook! Today the winds are light so we are taking advantage of it to get over to the English Company Islands, 25 miles away. Slow sailing, 4 knots, but it's been 2 months since we have seen winds under 20. We had few sailing through the 2 cuts between the island groups. Quads are rocky, for hiding looking, very desolate.

Jan 20

Set off at 9 am to catch the tide at the next pass through the channel. Quads, wind picked up to 30-35 by the time we got there. Then surfing in the waves! Then we clear channel over the 18 miles up the channel to Gove Bay. It is an incredible sea - clear blue, dark blue, red to clouds on. Charlotte did well going to windward with 2000 ft & 2000 ft.

Thurs June 24

Three days passed quickly at Jensen Bay. It was magical there, clear water, lots of fresh water on the island, fairy waterfalls down the rocky cliffs. Fidelio pulled in, we enjoyed catching up with Dan & Ann. Feel free come down and we had a few talk across the island to find and waterfall and some caves. The GPS got us there! Along with Ostica, Gust Lind & Bedouin, we had some big happy hours. Now, we are out here, rolling like crazy in less than 10 knots of wind. Rather uncomfortable, but I guess we should be glad it's not howling. Saw a big school of very small dolphins earlier, they were light gray & a little in color. Caught a big whale. The rain seems to be clearing, may be we will get some steady wind soon. Down to 3 knots. Fidelio passed us with their new sails. Bored for Port Essington or somewhere around Cape Don, en route to Darwin.

Fri June 25

It was a great night, perfect sailing. The wind picked up after dark, the seas straightened out and we flew along. Gust heeled trouble sleeping. Today we did 15-20 knots SE clear blue sky, relatively flat sailing with 4 sails up, poled out genoa and yankee forward. Fidelio is to the north of us, Gust Lind just south, and Tranquillity further to the south. His kind of fun - see all these sails! 24-hour run: 140 miles

Sat June 26

Rather bleary-eyed when I had to run the Sheila net this morning. Wind died last night until 2 am so we motored for several hours. The 4 boats were in sight the whole night. Saw mottos streaking across the sky. Decided not to go into Port Essington with Tranquillity and

Fidelio, rather continued on to Adigoro Bay with Quat Qimti. As
nearly the funeral approach was painful, dead into the wind. The
hundred then turned back here trying crossing! But it is nice here,
12. Long sandy beach, supposed to be lots of clams, and Cape Dan is
just around the corner. Almost finished with Australia, just the
funeral haul to Danvic left. 24 hour run - 115 miles

11th June 30

Quat dropped anchor in Danvic. Harbor after an overnight sail
from Cape Dan. Wonderful calm sea last night - to windward
in 10 knots, no seas, current with us, dodging reefs with chop.
Had a big party at Alcazar Bay with Quat Qimti (John & Laura) and
Edward Gold. Delivered 5 k to the light house, and were chased away
as soon as we arrived. After we happy to have finally made it
to Danvic. It has been a long 3 months of travel. At the gateway
to the Andean Ocean. Now of course the boys went to meet to deliver
ended up with Fidelio even though we didn't start with them.

12th July 16

Goodbye Australia! We are watching the low land slip away as
we sail west, bound for Bali via Ashmore Reef. At was a fine & busy
15. weeks in Danvic. Got to see so many old friends, and say
final goodbye to them as very few are going our way, to South
Africa, this year. Big reunion with Anthea, Patti Rick & Cleave,
the for tenacity they were far away from us in a marina on the
11th side of town. But Brian also spend some time with them
and with Andy on the way. He may not see another kid for a
long time. Spent an afternoon + evening with Ken & David on Seaside
nearly enjoyed their company. Saw Mike & Margaret on Athol and

paid them in person for the Auto pilot. control head they sent us.
met Leo on Moon light again and did some computer work
for the Europeans. More boats come in every day, so it was
nonstop partying at the various mancas + sailing clubs in Dawin.
Pretty tropical city, lots of palm trees. No rain at all in the
month of July! Brian got his contact lenses but is having
some trouble with them. Saw Harry Potter III and spent lots
of money. After 2 days of parties, we are burnt out and
happy to have a peaceful sail away from Australia. It has
been a great 8 1/2 months, we hate to leave, but Bali & the
Indian Ocean are beckoning! Of course we also got to see Teel
Tree, Bedawan, and Tranquillity. Brian got paid for helping them
clean and paint their bottom on the careening grid. We've careened
here also and slapped another coat of paint on - very handy.

Sat July 17

A rally, noisy night with very little wind, we did manage
to keep moving under Arries. There were several wind shifts - at
one point we were heading back to Dawin! A bit confusing for
Brian on, he's watch. No one else around. Today the wind has
been picking up steadily. The swell from the south is
annoying. Now it's 20 knots, broad reaching, 5-6 knots.

24 Show run - 93 miles

Sun July 18

Wind finally picked up last night after dark and we reefed and
reefed and reefed down to little jib and double - reefed main, still
doing 7 knots. Not so bad except when the occasional big wave.

idea through. Boom vang broke last night at the ball attached to the boom. A piece of spectra took care of it. Transgility left yesterday, 120 miles behind us, Anke 2 with Dietmar and Moonlight with Leo are ahead of us, lots of waves with white tops, clear blue sky, not much else. 24-hour run - 144 miles

Mon July 19
Beautiful night, clearing along, no sail changes necessary! Wind around 20-25 knots SE, waves 2 meters with some bigger ones. Two watch them rolling under the boat. We spotted the oil platform 10 miles away, sporting occasional bursts of flame and then subsiding. The wind in the middle of the ocean. No sign of life except as we will curve around mid night tonight. Had to jibe, so we are on the less comfortable tack for 4 days. Why do we do this to ourselves? Sailing is crazy. 24-hour run 145 miles

Tues July 20
Another calm night, good sleeping! Running under full sails, dead calm wind. Didn't have to do a thing all night. Still making good time, making less. Thomas caught a tuna this morning. We passed Fishmore Reef before mid night. Weather is too nice to stop. This is wonderful sailing! 24-hour run 148 miles

Wed July 21
Lots of phosphorescence in the water last night, sparsely wake. Impact 15-18 knot wind. Seas are very down. The spectra still there, not left Down! Transgility pulled into Godmore this morning. Anke 2 left today. Chalk is really fueling - averaging 1 knot/hr. hours at a time. 24-hour run = 168 miles
~~off this is a sailing record for us!~~

Thurs July 22

Finally spotted some ships yesterday - 2 Indonesian boats going to windward, a big cargo at sunset, and one long-liner early in the morning. Another calm night, wind was down, some but we still maintained 6 knots. Today we gave up the mizzen and the yankee, making time while we can, anticipating lighter winds tonight as we approach the islands. 5 flying fish on deck this morning - I could hear them flopping at night. Reed a cat! 24-hour run 163 miles.

Fri July 23

Horrible current we have been bucking since the middle of last night, had to motor some to overcome it. Bali is cloud-covered, can't see the volcano. Approach is painful with big standing waves. We will be anchored by 10 am. All in all, a great sail!

Thurs Aug 5

Almost 2 weeks in Bali, it flew by. We tried to do as much as possible in the time we were there. Spent a week in the mountains as the anchorage was poor and no other boats were there. Took a trip to the volcano and went on an elephant safari. Buren was so thrilled! Stumbled on to a kite-flying competition one day. The kites were huge - 30 feet wide, some with 200-foot tails. At least 10 men handled them, big live on a reel. The kites were launched to the accompaniment of brass gongs, wooden drum and gamelan (kind of like xylophones). It was a colorful scene. Most of the Balinese were dressed in 2 different barongs, lots of black & white checks to represent the yin-yang of life. Tran-gully arrived last Wednesday, Moonlight & Anne 2 at Tuesday. We took another drive with Rick & Mary to Ubud, then to a 1000-year-old temple at

Leaving Kawi, we descended stone steps through nice paddies
into a valley with a swift river flowing with waterfalls
along the rock face. The temple was carved out of the rock
walls. It was magical. We loved the Balinese countryside,
but the cities were loved and crowded with motorbikes. They
made them 'motorbikes' and they were very pesky! So crowded
everywhere and the street howlers were at millions of times.
We had got a lot of cool stuff though - silver earrings, little
palest leaves, wood carvings and paintings. The silk batik
was absolutely fabulous, but I just enjoyed looking at it.
We had been buying DVDs for a dollar a piece! We would
have stayed longer if the harbor had been nicer - the water was
brown and the air stank like burning garbage. It was one of the
most beautiful we have ever been in - quite a disappointment.
Now we are headed for Cooa looking Bali is feeling behind
us and Cooa is just visible to starboard. The reefs are
full of delicious fruits for the week ahead, we are happy.
I have experienced Bali, but glad to be in clear water again.
I had glimpses we got of Balinese culture were quite
interesting - temples everywhere. Big ornate ones, small ones
in villages, tiny ones in individual yards. We were taken
away morning at 5 am by the sound of Muslim singing. The
traditional view of the valley from the anchorage was nice. It was
filled up there, with a big inviting lake. I don't forget the sight
of people crouching in the rice fields with wooden paddles on
their heads, women carrying concrete bricks on their heads, men in motorcycle
helmets fishing in artificial concrete canals.

The people were small, good-looking, and friendly. They wondered how we could have skin color the same as theirs. Bali was an interesting place.

Fri Aug 6

Calm. Bright, beam reaching in 10 knots south wind, dodging long liners along the south coast of Java. Wind continues light today, still from the south. Pretty pleasant sailing conditions. Thomas caught the first mako of the Indian. Ocean early to be a morning. Brian started 8th grade today - it is painful to be a teacher again. 24-hour run: 126 miles

Sat Aug 7

The stars were incredible last night - we will really miss the night skies of the Southern Hemisphere. Today has been a bit of a pain. Light, fleaky winds, hard to steer the boat straight. A big clouded system looms and we can't get out from under it. So we sail some, then we bang around some. Keeps us busy though. 24-hour run: 134 miles
Saw dolphins jumping - they were huge - 10 feet long. They came over to inspect the boat but found us too boring.

Sun Aug 8

Another uneventful day at sea, just the way we like them! Wind was up these morning, did 8 knots for several hours before sun came out a reef in the main for a few hours. The southerly swell got up to 3 meters while the wind was up. 24-hr run: 147 miles

Mon Aug 9

Passed Christmas Island today - it has visible the entire day. Seagulls flying around. Wind 10-12 knots, speed down. 24-hr run: 148 miles

Wed Aug 10 2004
Wind died last night, after we passed Christmas Island and no longer had the option of stopping there. Less than 10 knots all night. It did not improve Thomas' position to hear that Bedouin and just quit made it to Cocoa in 3 days from Christmas. We are stuck in the wind holes for a day or so. No big deal really - it is pleasant enough out here, but we had hoped to be in Friday morning.
24-hour run - 119 miles

Wed Aug 11
Another pleasant day at sea. Wind picked up enough last night so we were floating along at 5 knots, calm seas, very comfortable! Wind picked up enough today so we are doing 6 knots. Looks like we may be able to make it Friday after all. 24-hour run: 130 miles

Wed Aug 12
Wind came up just before dinner last night - spoiled my enjoyment of the wine I had just opened! At sea a bumpy, sleepless night, but we made good progress. The other boats made landfall in Pines today, we will be in before noon tomorrow. Wind 24-hour run: 149 miles

Thu Sept 5
We had planned to leave Cocoa today, but a cyclone is sitting to the west of us and we had thunderstorms last night, so we are staying put. Arrived Fri Aug 13 at day break, what a beautiful place! We have enjoyed all 3 weeks here. Got to know some of the people, Bob & Sue on Carefree, Christian & Terrence on the canoe from Bregille, Steve & Julie on Dos Tristes, Gustaf &

Caroline with baby Sasha or Bonnie, ~~Brian~~ ^{Brian} on why knot, Woody on Lew Key. Had a great birthday party for Thomas, lots of people got drunk. Tranquillity brewed and Brian is happy to spend time with Rick. Leo on moonlight just arrived today. The days pass pleasantly. The water colors are all shades of turquoise, lots of palm trees ashore, a white sandy beach, a fun snorkel, cutters with raw water and a partly area on shore. The boys wind surf. The South African boats be down. Just Gint and Golden. Sorrenga with Clive, Anne-Marie, Clare & Shawn were here when we arrived. Lots of socializing happy hours every evening and several pot lucks. Bob on Carafree died yesterday at sea. Sue is still a day from Rodrigues, all alone with his body. I feel so sorry for her. We hope she makes it in safely tomorrow.

Fri Sept 10

We finally tore ourselves away from Cocas yesterday. Had one more party died night. Forgot to mention Thomas' birthday. Back where a lot of people got really drunk. Hans on Barn. There could really hold his liquor. For my birthday, Rick set up his generator and TV on shore and we watched Captain Ken. Tidelis with Jan & Ann arrived, it was great to see them one last time, also Shadowfax with Tom & Sorrenga. Several boats were planning to leave but only we & Bacanas made it out the pass, they going north to Chagos. It is quite rough, hard to do any thing on board. 25 knots SE, big seas, but going fast. 24-hour run - 163 miles.

Sept 11

Today is a bit easier - Thomas & I are feeling better. Still rough, but the wind is down a bit. If it went for those southerly rollers, it wouldn't be so bad. The eggs went laying earlier - they have never laid before. Forgot to mention the rip at Cocoa - a cut with clear water and lots of fish - big fun to dive. I miss my exercise after 3 days of lying around, it is very wet on deck. You can up here for short periods now. But the weather has cleared, we seem to have sailed out of the squalls, beautiful blue sky. The swells have still 10 feet, but the breaking seas are gone. Oh-ho now! 160 miles

Sept 12

Always some excitement! The wind did back down last night after midnight. May or tranquillity had predicted. Thomas took the 2nd reef out. Soon then, we heard that awful sound - the sound of something breaking. The boom had broken in half at the very fitting, which we had just placed in Bole. We took the sail down, tied the boom to the deck, and went back to bed. A few hours later, at sunrise, Thomas lifted a piece of wood we picked up in Vancouver to fit inside the boom. It was a perfect fit and we are back in business. The wind is down to 15-20 and seas are down to 2 meters. Sailing is much more comfortable and we can be outside without getting a shower. Oh! hair run - 152 miles

Sept 13

We know there would not be an easy trip, but we did not expect so much trouble. After a few hours with fog, a clear sky, and sunshine can't miss, we heard another hair! The sound of breaking. This time it is as the feeder stay, some thing snapped at the top. I think a yarder on the spare jockey, and we hope that the

furler halyard will hold the weight for the next 10 days. It is impossible to go up the mast to inspect it in the rolling seas. Heedless to say, morale is a bit low on board, we are all wondering what will happen next. Wind was around 20 knots when the furler busted and we were all out on deck. 24-hour run: 155 miles
Thurs Sept. 14

Nothing broke in the last 24 hours, but we still passed a sleepless night, with the boat rolling, worrying, jumping up at every sound. I feel another halyard around the top of the furler this morning, to discontinue the weight. Thomas made a splint for the boom, from an old life line stanchion. Now we are sailing with the Yankee, stay sail, full main + mizzen in 10-15 knots of wind, not too bad! Life goes on as usual. 24-hour run: 154 miles
Wed Sept 15

Withd backed more to the east, so Thomas had to climb up the mast and put up a block for the spinnaker pole topping lift. For the first time we are using all the spare halyards on the main mast! Running under pole-d out Yankee was comfortable, we got to catch up on our sleep. Wind veered more easterly today, so we are almost dead downwind, rolling a lot. 24-hour run - 156 miles
Thurs Sept 16

Hit the halfway mark yesterday around 8 p.m. We celebrated with chocolate! Wind went light and easterly so our speed dropped, the boat rolled all night. For three days now I see the same bird at sunrise + sunset, flying behind the boat. Wonder where he goes during the day. Our best all morning but now it is clearing up. 24-hour run: 139 miles

Thurs Sept 17

Another excellent full day, the way we like them! Lots of sunshine, with easterly about 15 knots. Can tell the change in time zones now, we were ready to go to sleep before the sun went down! And the new moon finally last night. The Indian Ocean was empty, 24-hr run: 147 miles

Fri Sept 18

Another day, a lot of empty ocean. Getting tired of eating noodles and instant food! Brian is even beginning to burn out on reading. We have enough power to let him play computer games some. Can see the end now - more days. Should get us to Rodrigues, lots of empty ocean off here. About centred at 15-20, ESE to SE - pole out, pole down, reef nationally. Trying to take it easy on the rig. 24-hr run: 154 miles

Sat Sept 19

The wind started picking up last night at sundown, and howled and squaled all night. Then the big GPS died and it took us an hour to get the hand held going, as it had lost its memory. Wind was repeating distance in statute miles. SigL - what next? Wind is down today but we are still doing without the main sail. We got ~~out~~ big again. Sunny seas. 24-hr run: 155 miles

Sun Sept 20

After an otherwise night of sail changes and squalls with lots of rain, we finally settled on a sailplan of no main, double-reefed main, 100% Blosing 20-25 with big reefing sea, but was fairly so we quite far off the wind. Wish it would calm down a bit for the 12 days, 24-hr run: 155 miles.

Tues Sept 21

Rolling down the road, on the lone stretch! Wind is down to 15 knots although seas are still big. Air is much warmer with the easterly winds. Last night was squally again but not as fierce. Other boats are having plenty of problems on this trip. Dos Tintas broke their Monitor self-steering, Sterling broke their self-steering and ripped the main sail, Jean-Claude on La Brigne, who lost his Asten steering just 1 day out of Cocas, apparently bent his keel this morning but seems to be okay. There will be lots of wound-licking going on in Rodrigues! We still expect landfall early tomorrow morning if the wind does not die completely. 24-hr run: 154 miles

Wed Sept 22

Land ho! Wind lightened during the night but we still rolled along. Turned ENE, had to jibe. Rolling was unbearable. But we are almost there. It was the fastest trip Charlotte has ever made - averaged over 150 miles a day. Will be happy to drop the hook. Here on Born Free we still have, so we will have a familiar face.

Tues Oct 5.

Fun time in Rodrigues - it was an unexpectedly pleasant stop. When we arrived there was only Hans on Born Free and Pierdon on Quor Vadis. By the time we left there were over a dozen boats. Many boats from Cocas - Dos Tintas with Steve & Julie, Shadow sail with Tom & Serena, Woody on Low Key, Jean-Claude on La Brigne, and a bunch of Dutch boats, including Sterling with Rick & Hergette. The vegetable bars were so delicious - crisp and infert. Lizard, and Phoenix beer is tasty. We piggied out of baguettes, charissots, etc., and austered hours. Big parties at most every night. I found a jeweller

Swiss guy - and had my Tupperware covered people eat. He invited us
to his home for dinner. We took a day trip around the island with
a bunch of other boats - not much to see but we all had a good time.
It was hard to leave but we were drinking too much. The town was
very friendly, happy to have visitors. We stayed the overnight - Thomas
had a rest stop, and I packed the gear. He applied the bon with
pieces of aluminum so it can't get off all. We ordered a new GPS from
Thomas. Everyone was lying stiff on their boats. Light winds forecast
so we are off to Mauritius.
Oct 6

Very peaceful night, the way we like them. Winds 15 knots on leave,
passed out part of the time. Not going real fast, but don't care too, it's
only a 350-mile trip. Only other ships out here are Tintoo and the
Mauritius-Rodrigues supply boats. 24th Nov: 145 miles
Helmets, Mils, & baby Amalie from Dille jewels - look up on internet
Oct 7

The Indian Ocean is here and empty! Although Thomas did catch a
few yesterday morning. Bitter refused to eat any more fish - too much on
Bouvier Reef. Another quiet night. Could see Dos Tintoo all the time.
Cargo passing N-S, right between us. Song happy birthday to
Thomas on the VHF. The high light of the day is Mary's Dawnward Let,
and sunset in the evening. Running as slow as can for today. He
also don't cruise much before sunrise. 24-hr run: 135 miles
Oct 15

Made Landfall at Port Louis, Mauritius, last Friday morning, along
with Dos Tintoo. Had to tie up along the wall at the morning, there
are other ships. Port Louis is a typical nasty 3rd world city
and with some remnants of past splendour. We took a taxi to

with Tom + Serena off Shadaw for the center of the island. Looked at an unimpressive crater and a brodel boat factory with seals models of famous his torical boats. Got stuck longer then we wanted in the marina when the wind died for 2 days. Finally left yesterday morning for Reunion. Trip started horribly with several hours of motoring into light head winds, then 25 knots hard to wind ward, before the wind finally backed and eased around sunset: how we are roundly the south coast with a spectacular view of the mountain rising from the ocean up into the clouds.

Thurs Oct 22

Spent a pleasant week in St. Pierre at the marina. It flew a gale for several days, then died completely for a few days. A enjoyed swimming at the beach just past the breakwater. We took an exciting bus ride to a crater in the interior with Dos Tintas and hiked for a few hours. The roads were extremely narrow with tight hairpin curves, lots of near accidents! Reunion is quite lush and green. We enjoyed the best baguettes in the world. Had several dinners and happy hours, time passed quickly. Left today at noon with a light southerly wind, can't quite hold the course. Tintas + Stella Mours left with us.

Fri Oct 23

A couple of small squalls last night - the wind died completely then came back with all sails hoisted. Did okay until sunset when it lightened again. Now motoring for a few hours since we can't hold the course to windward. Guess there is going to be a long slow sail! At least we have lots of good food this time, plenty of beer. Other boats are out of sight. Water very blue. Enjoying the hot sun while I still can! 24-hr run - 114 miles

Oct 24
Peaceful night & beautiful morning. Thomas had to call a freighter last night so they changed course to avoid us. Wind backed to the east so we are pulled out with 4 sails up, still making 3 knots or less.
The wind will come up some tonight. It is comfortable at least!
14 hr run - 107 miles

Nov Oct 25 -
We crossed most of the night with the mizzen drifted up, 2 headsails, 1 full main. Took it down when the wind picked up early morning. We made 5 knots occasionally today. Dos Tater is steadily pulling ahead, Stella, Mavis feeling behind. Woody got to Darwin, 18 days from Rodrigues, 11 wind over 20 k. 24-hr run - 93 miles

Nov Oct 26 -
Had to jibe yesterday evening - what a hassle. The roll on the starboard bow kept us awake most of the night. The wind has backed to the north now and we are aboard reeking at 5.5 knots, more comfortable now. At least the north wind is warm! 24-hr run - 123 miles

Nov Oct 27
Woke up to north winds, then they backed to NW. Had to motor for 1 hour until the wind came around to the south. We are happy to be back on Charlotte track! Talked to Piers on Quaker this morning, he is only 40 miles ahead of us. We are hard on the wind and last hoping it will turn to SE soon. 24-hr run: 127 miles

Nov Oct 28
Great sailing for a change! Picked up current before sunset and did 1 knots for a few hours. Wind backed more to the east so we put up 11 sails at dawn now, making good time with 4 sails. Paving on Dos Tater now. Stella Mavis & Spelling are behind us. Also had 100 knots for the next 5 days. 4 hr has been a warm sunny day after an overcast, but 34y night. 24-hr run: 155 miles

Fri Oct 29.

Today is not a wonderful day - the sun is shining; 15 K wind from the wrong direction. We tried motor-sailing for a while, but were making little progress against the wind and current. We did see a whale this afternoon and we have had booby birds with us all day. Morale is pretty high here, but we are trying to keep it together. 24-hr run - 117 miles.
Sat Oct 30

Happy Halloweem! The gale hit today. Motored all night, made good progress for a change. Lucky for us, Dos Tintos warned us of the approaching SW gale. Been in it now for several hours, seas are building now, we have up-stayed no. 2 yankee, double-reefed mizzen, doing $6\frac{1}{2}$ knots. It's a bit too much for me. But we are making progress. 24-hr run: 77 miles.
Sun Oct 31

It was quite a night. Second front line hit around 8 pm and blew 40 knots for a while. We had to dump the staysail in a hurry. It was wild out, took hours for Thomas to get the nerve to go back out there when the wind abated. The weather has turned much cooler. Today at sunrise the wind backed to east of south so we are sailing upright again. Everyone had a wild ride last night! We talk every morning on Pielagos net as well as Maps.

24-hr run: 132 miles

Mon ~~Oct~~ Nov 1

Last night was perfect, until around 3 am, when the wind started dying. We were paled out with 4 sails. Got to catch up on our sleep! Today has been very light motored for a few hours, now waiting for the wind to come back up. It blew about 11, but even Thomas is sick of the sound of the engine. It is fun having all the morning net scheduled - everyone else is waiting for wind too. 24-hr run - 128 miles.

Nov 2
Thought we had clear sailing from here on in to the coast - but! a course
has developed, coming up, blowing 20-25 SW so far. Stealing of course
is nervous about it blowing a gale, and there were some gale reports, we
just know where. We are taking every few hours with the South African
and with our friends. Our boats & Tintor are have to Stealing is
sailing east. We keep on going and we are west of all of them. Chances are
not amount to much, but no one feels like taking chances. Now that
finally have a good wind and a favorable current, it is difficult to slow
down. Tintor was surrounded by 6 whales today, it was cool but also
when frightening for them. We would have been killed! So we will see
what the night will bring, not much sleep! That's for sure.
24-hour run - 139 miles - Perfect night last night, 15 SE - full sails
Nov 3

Front never come through last night, clouds come in around 3 am
and wind died. Today we have light west winds, so we are motoring the
last 50 miles, get to sail some at 8 knots with the current, wind is
variable. Finally made out. The African coastline about 22 miles
off. We will be in some time this afternoon. At has been an
appreciating trip! 24, for run. 120 miles

Nov 11

Michael feelings about South Africa. We spent 3 days at the Tug
Tug, married in Richards Bay - Shearwater was there, also Heats
! instant and ABV, Stealing & Stella Maria followed us in. We
saw a ship to the Huddlestone Game Park with Stella Maria
stealing - had a fantastic time! We saw wild beasts, buffaloes,
many hogs, rhinos, 30 deer, giraffes, Inpa deer, baboons, monkeys
all kinds, kudu, and one elephant. En can feed a rhino
meat stock at one point and had to turn around. The landscape was
very stark - rolling hills & plains with few large trees, it is